Halden People and Travel Guide

Leave and working time

New colleagues receive 27 days of paid annual leave in their first full calendar year. Leave requests go through the rota application and need the approval of the line manager at least two weeks ahead. Unused days do not lapse straight away, because the carry over rule allows a balance to move into the first quarter of the next year.

Parents may take an additional sixteen weeks of shared parental leave, which can be divided into up to three separate blocks. The people team needs written notice eight weeks before the first block starts. Pay during this period follows the company scheme described in the benefits booklet given to every employee on joining.

Overtime is paid at one and a half times the basic rate for weekday shifts and double time on public holidays. Time recorded in the attendance system is rounded to the nearest quarter of an hour. Supervisors confirm overtime on the Friday of each week so that it can go into the following payroll run without manual correction.

Travel and expenses

Rail journeys longer than three hours may be booked in first class, and every other trip is standard class. Tickets are bought through the Voyara portal so that the travel team can contact staff during a disruption. Taxi receipts must show the date, the fare and the name of the operator before finance will accept them.

Meals on business trips are reimbursed up to a daily limit of 62 euros, including tips and drinks taken with food. Alcohol bought separately is never reimbursed. Claims are submitted with photographs of the receipts, and a claim older than ninety days needs

a signature from the finance director before it can be paid.

Staff who drive their own car on company business claim a mileage rate of 41 cents for each kilometre. The driver must hold business insurance cover and upload the certificate once a year. Fines for parking and speeding remain the personal responsibility of the driver in every case and cannot be added to an expense claim.

Learning and wellbeing

Each employee has a personal learning budget of 900 euros per year for courses, books and conference tickets. The budget is requested through the learning catalogue and a manager approves the purpose rather than the provider. Any amount that remains unspent returns to the central fund when the financial year closes.

Confidential counselling is available through the Brightharbor helpline at any hour of the day. Six free sessions are offered per issue, and neither the company nor the line manager is told who has called. Trained mental health first aiders are also present at each site and their names are listed in the canteen.

The annual health check takes place in the second half of October in a mobile clinic parked beside the main entrance. It covers blood pressure, eyesight and a short lifestyle questionnaire. Results go only to the employee, and the nurse can refer anyone who needs further attention to their own doctor.

Staff who cycle to work can use the secure shelter behind building two, which is opened with the same badge as the front door. The tax scheme for buying a bicycle allows a maximum purchase of 2400 euros, repaid from gross salary across three years. Showers and lockers are on the ground floor next

to the gym.